

Moto Edge 50 Ultra

Wood be good

Moto skipped the 'Ultra' variant in last year's Moto Edge 40 series. We only got the Moto Edge 40 and the Moto Edge 40 Neo last year. This year, Motorola went back to its 2022 naming strategy and we got the Moto Edge 50 Fusion and the Moto Edge 50 Ultra both this year, along with the Moto Edge 50 Pro, which was launched first. So the Moto Edge 50 Ultra is the top-spec device in the Edge 50 series and Motorola has set the bar high, in terms of what to expect from the smartphone. Let's take a look if the Moto Edge 50 Ultra was able to fare well:

DESIGN

Right off the bat, the Moto Edge 50 Ultra looks superb from the moment I set my eyes on the smartphone. Despite Moto's new Edge 50 series being super pretty in itself, Motorola has gone a step ahead and put a wooden back panel on the Moto Edge 50 Ultra. Now, this is not actual wood, but the material is made of recycled parts of wood. Now, I am not sure how much wood is there in the whole composition, but the back panel feels wooden to the touch.

Not only this, Motorola has made sure that the experience of opening their new Moto Edge 50 Ultra is exquisite. The brand has also added a scent to the box and the back panel of the Moto Edge 50 Ultra so that when users open and start using their new phone, it should smell good. Great touch! The Moto Edge 50 Ultra also has a nice woody scent on the back panel. The smell enhances if you rub the back panel. This is probably one of the most creative ways I have seen any brand enhance the unboxing experience for users, and it works really well. How long the scent lasts on the back panel is yet to be seen.

Apart from the wooden back, the camera module merges into the back



panel nicely, just the three cameras aren't placed symmetrically. We are also getting a metal frame, along with the subtle "Dolby Atmos" branding on top of the frame. Up front, there is a curved screen with a hole-punch display. The charging port and SIM tray are placed on the bottom, along with the speaker grille. The power button and volume rockers are placed at the right side of the frame, and up top also, we are getting a speaker outlet.

Furthermore, we are getting IP68 dust and water resistance along with Corning Gorilla Glass Victus protection, so the device is also rugged. The Moto Edge 50 Ultra isn't as slim as the Edge 50 Pro or the Fusion, but at 8.6mm, I'll still consider it slim.

In terms of design, there is nothing that goes against the Moto Edge 50 Ultra, except for the camera placement maybe, but that isn't something that will influence any buying decisions. So yes, the design is very good. It is slim and light, it has all the protections and ratings in

place, and it looks extremely good. I have seen many people buying these wooden texture skins for their smartphones, so Motorola giving that out of the box is very good. Add to that, the scent and this makes for a very pleasing device in terms of design and feel.

DISPLAY

The display of the Moto Edge 50 Ultra is a 6.7-inch LTPO AMOLED display with a 1.5K resolution and up to 144Hz refresh rate. On paper, this is a brilliant display. It is also a 10-bit display so there is enough range in terms of the colours as well. This is also a Pantone-validated display, which means that it is capable of rendering the full range of Pantone colors accurately.

This is a good display. At 144Hz, it is extremely responsive and smooth. Scrolling through menus and apps is a pleasant experience and you will never feel like the display is slow or unresponsive. It is also extremely bright. The display is claimed to come with a peak brightness of 2,500 nits. But how much is it actually? I used the Lux Meter for testing the brightness on the Moto Edge 50 Ultra and under bright sunlight, the smartphone showcased a good luminance of 1962 nits. So yes, the sunlight visibility is not an issue and even in the scorching Delhi sun, this display doesn't let you down.

Coming to colour accuracy, I ran the Calman ColorChecker analysis on the Moto Edge 50 Ultra. Here also, the smartphone showcased exceptional colour accuracy. The smartphone was able to achieve a DeltaE of about 1.5, which is great since a DeltaE of under 3 is considered good for smartphones, so this is great in that sense.

The Moto Edge 50 Ultra also supports HDR10+ and Dolby Vision so watching content on platforms like Netflix, Amazon Prime, or YouTube is a pleasing experience and you can watch your movies and TV shows in high dynamic range.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, it is right up there with other smartphones in this category, and smartphones that have been launched with the Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 chipset. Be it in terms of how the smartphone performs